Spirituality-related associations in Croatia's media space

Detailed research and collection plan | 19 September 2026 | DigiKat

Croatian working title: Udruge iz područja duhovnosti u hrvatskom medijskom prostoru: vidljivost, glasovi i načini predstavljanja.

Central question: Which associations become visible, through whose voices and which public roles, and how does media representation relate to their documented activities and self-presentation?

Recommended design: a register-linked study of calendar 2025, followed by selected organisational and event investigations. Combine a national discovery screen with verified article-to-organisation links, separate communication channels, computational exploration and close reading. Extend the time series only after the 2025 design works. This document specifies the next stage; the expanded collection and substantive analyses described below have not yet been run.

1. What carries over from the reference study

The analytical model is the existing *Demokršćanstvo u medijskom prostoru* report: move from a clear account of the material to themes, vocabulary, voices, differences between media, and portraits of particular moments. Its technical companion keeps provenance, repeated-text controls and uncertainty reviewable. The associations study adds an organisation register, historical identity checks and a distinction between publicity and independent editorial attention.

Reference-study component	Adaptation for associations
Visibility over time	Which organisations appear, how often, in which months and in which channels?
Thematic map	What activities, social issues and events bring associations into coverage?
Language and principles	How are spirituality, care, wellbeing, solidarity, expertise and public benefit invoked?
Different voices	Does the organisation speak, or do journalists, partners, officials and critics define it?
Media and platforms	How do editorial articles, organisational publicity, institutional announcements and public discussion differ?
Monthly portraits	What explains a burst of attention, and what remains visible after the event?
Interpretive discussion	Which public roles are made available to different organisations, and when is spiritual identity foregrounded or absent?

Reuse the research structure and reporting discipline, not the Christian-democracy labels, ten-topic solution or sentiment assumptions. Topics and frames must be developed from this material. The first paper should make a defensible account of representation possible before attempting explanations of influence or public attitudes.

2. Starting evidence and study boundaries

The completed exploration provides a reconciled administrative frame and a discovery corpus. The values below come from the saved register, media and candidate audits, rather than a new retrieval.

Existing resource	Verified baseline and implication
Register snapshot	1,325 entries across 21 counties, dated 11 September 2026. The PDF and JSON reconcile exactly.
General monitored feed	41,748,837 records from 1 January 2021 to 10 September 2026; the 2025 slice contains 8,514,361 raw records. These are vendor records, not a census of Croatian journalism.
Initial 2025 screen	1,043 names searched; 248 have candidates and 795 do not. Another 282 await adequate identity rules.
Retrieved candidates	3,806 distinct items and 3,961 organisation-item pairs. Their identity and substantive relevance remain unvalidated.
Development material	A purposive 60-organisation pilot, 453 candidate review records, an apparent-miss queue and 15 separately recorded AI readings. None is a held-out human accuracy estimate.
Identity enrichment	17 register entries have documentary profile proposals across nine source groups. Only 60 register rows contain a website field; missing websites require discovery, not assumptions about inactivity.

Population. Keep the supplied administrative frame intact. It is not a census of religious communities, informal movements, all spiritual activity or all Croatian civil society. Do not exclude humanitarian or cultural associations merely because a name appears nonreligious. Classify documented orientation, activities, legal entity, network position and channels separately; preserve unknown values.

Primary period. Use 1 January through 31 December 2025. Verify each association's existence and relevant names during that period. Report newly founded organisations with their actual eligible months. The estimand is visibility in 2025 among eligible members of the September 2026 frame. Organisations dissolved before the snapshot are missing from that frame; studying the complete historical 2025 population would require a separate reconstruction.

Media scope. Make editorial articles the primary representation corpus: web news, print articles and sufficiently complete news/interview broadcast transcripts. Build companion corpora for organisational communication, partners and public institutions, and public discussion. Keep format separate from editorial origin: a website page is not necessarily journalism, and a social post may link to a news article. Count the post and article in their respective media, with an explicit connection between them.

Search the general feed without a Catholic or spirituality keyword prefilter. An article about an association's volunteering belongs even if it contains no religious vocabulary. Include sources serving Croatian publics after source review; code publication country, language and event location separately. Cross-border and diaspora material should have an explicit supplementary scope. Do not infer those attributes from a domain suffix alone.

3. Research questions and claims to examine

1. **Visibility and inequality:** Which eligible organisations receive substantive editorial attention, and how concentrated and persistent is that attention? How different is the picture when own communication is included?
2. **Public roles:** Are associations represented as service providers, religious communities, cultural organisers, wellbeing providers, civic advocates, sources of expertise or objects of dispute?
3. **Identity:** When do media explicitly describe an association's spiritual or religious orientation? When do articles foreground activities while leaving that identity unstated?
4. **Voice and authority:** Who defines the organisation and its activities? Does the association explain itself, and are beneficiaries, volunteers, public officials, experts or critics heard?
5. **Transformation across channels:** Which parts of an organisation's self-presentation survive, disappear or change when a story enters editorial coverage or public discussion?
6. **Events and differences:** What produces attention peaks, and how do patterns vary across localities, organisational activities, networks and media settings?

Treat possible explanations as competing propositions. Service activities may make spiritual identity less prominent; disputes may make it more prominent; strong local ties or communications capacity may explain visibility otherwise attributed to orientation. Geography, organisational resources, event frequency and collection coverage are alternative explanations to examine. Neither a low article count nor an unfavourable passage establishes media exclusion, discrimination or organisational failure.

4. Build an evidence-backed identity catalogue

Retain the existing UDR ID as the study key. Add a legal registration number or OIB only when an official source establishes the crosswalk; the supplied UDR ID is not assumed to be either. The Ministry's Register of Associations entry point links to the official public register. Use it for legal identity and available dated records, then corroborate public-facing names with organisational sources.

For each organisation, record legal and shortened names; historical names and effective dates; Croatian inflected forms; documented acronyms; locality and previous seats; official domains and account identifiers; distinctive programmes; and parent, branch or partner relationships. Each alias needs a source, retrieval date, applicable dates, entity scope, ambiguity note and review status. Programme and representative names are secondary discovery keys and require evidence of the organisation's involvement.

Separate official self-description from independent evidence of activity. A statute can support a declared purpose; a dated event report can support activity on that occasion. Neither proves the scale or success of the work. A current website cannot by itself establish that the same identity or channel existed in 2025. Use dated annual reports, archived pages and contemporaneous sources where available.

Begin detailed enrichment with the existing 60 cases, which cover lexical variety and all counties but are not representative. Develop identity rules across the full frame in parallel with this bounded pilot. Prioritise shared names, generic phrases, missing channels and organisations with no retrieval, rather than only the names with many candidates. Record unresolved cases explicitly.

Network rule. A network mention is assigned to the network, and to a specific legal association only when the passage identifies that association. A shared website is insufficient to assign every page to every branch. Keep Zdenac entities, yoga centres, SKAC centres and cultural umbrella

branches distinct until documentary evidence resolves the relationship. A later network-level analysis can aggregate confirmed relationships without erasing the original entity links.

5. Collection sources and reproducible search

5.1 Use three complementary collection routes

Route	Work to perform	Analytical role
Local general media feed	Search all eligible 2025 records with versioned identity rules; keep original fields and source provenance.	Reproducible monitored corpus and coverage inventory.
Unfiltered daily exports	Inventory and search every available 2025 export; reconcile IDs, dates, versions and overlaps with the merged feed.	Recover candidates lost by the standalone-word filter and measure incremental yield.
Targeted web discovery	Search verified names, channels, publisher archives and documented events; save search logs and accessible evidence.	Discover aliases, inspect apparent misses and assemble case dossiers; a separately identified supplement.

The merged feed's newer collection applies a standalone Croatian word i filter. The exploratory check found four candidate records removed across twelve fixed dates, but those dates are not a probability sample and do not supply an annual correction factor. Scan the complete available unfiltered 2025 exports for the new stage. Freeze a file manifest first: some exports may differ in revision from the merged database. Preserve both provenances instead of calling every raw-only result a filter loss.

If a daily export is missing or unreadable, log the gap and keep the merged-feed baseline distinct. A unified item collection can support descriptions of what was found, but rates require a corresponding deduplicated monitored population for the same sources and dates. An unknown raw-feed denominator means no rate for that expanded collection.

Targeted search supplements must remain identifiable even when their records overlap the monitored feed. Report baseline-only and baseline-plus-supplement results separately. Search-engine result totals are not counts of articles or measures of media attention.

5.2 Apply a standard search ladder

For each pilot organisation, use this ordered search protocol, retaining queries with zero results:

1. Search the complete legal name, shortened official name and documented historical names, including diacritic-preserving and folded variants.
2. Search documented aliases and inflections; combine ambiguous aliases with locality, distinctive programme, verified account/domain or another identity anchor.
3. Search the verified official site and accounts for dated 2025 activities and an archive or press section. These identify events and source statements, not independent coverage.
4. Search publisher archives for the same names and documented events. Include local outlets around the registered seat and activity locations, then regional, national and specialist outlets. Build the outlet list from observed coverage and source inventories, not assumed completeness.
5. Search programme or public representative names only with organisational context. Inspect their role at the time; do not turn every story about a representative into a story about the association.

6. Investigate apparent misses by tracing at least one documented 2025 event through official, partner and editorial sources. Record inaccessible pages and uncertain publication dates.

For external search, use a common initial budget: inspect the first 20 unique results for each of four core query families (legal name, alias with an anchor, own channel, and dated activity). Stop earlier when results end. Log engine, date, locale, exact query, result rank, inspected URL and disposition. Run up to two additional targeted rounds where new aliases or events emerge. Stop after two consecutive rounds yield neither a new relevant item nor a new identity clue, or after the recorded time budget is exhausted. This is a reproducible discovery boundary, not proof of exhaustive retrieval.

Apply the same core budget to every pilot organisation. Extensions for specific investigations are recorded separately. A search-engine date restriction is only a discovery aid: check the article's publication date, event date and any update date on the page. Search results and publisher archives can change, so save the accessible evidence and access timestamp rather than expecting identical rankings later.

5.3 Concrete query templates

These examples specify proposed discovery queries, not validated production rules. Boolean and proximity notation below describes local matching logic; translate it into the syntax actually supported by each search interface. Do not add negative search terms globally before inspecting what they exclude.

Organisation or case	Example search or local rule	Required identity check
Breza	"udruga Breza"; "Breza" "Osijek"; local Breza variants near an organisation cue or documented programme	Distinguish the association from the tree, place names and other organisations; an Osijek reference is supportive, not sufficient alone.
SKAC Palma / Split	"SKAC Palma"; "SKAC Split"; "Studentski katolički centar" "Palma"	Verify the particular centre. A generic SKAC mention or a tag naming several centres stays at network/unresolved level.
Korablja	"Korablja" "udruga"; documented Korablja and Arka combinations	Separate the legal association from the wider Arka/L'Arche network and ordinary uses of the word.
Padmasana	"Padmasana" "udruga"; "Padmasana" "budistički"	Distinguish the association from a yoga posture. Activity outside the registered seat does not disqualify a genuine match.
Zdenac	Complete registered name plus a documented place or programme	Resolve the legal entity; a shared network domain does not settle the link.
KRAK	Full-name and finite inflection variants; acronym plus Christian/academic context	Require the organisation, rather than a common noun or unrelated acronym.

Organisation or case	Example search or local rule	Required identity check
Generic slogan names	Exact legal phrase plus explicit organisation naming or other corroborating evidence	Long exact strings such as U ZDRAVOM TIJELU ZDRAV DUH can still be ordinary language.
Cultural branches	Umbrella name plus branch and place variants	The branch must occur in the article's content, not only in navigation listing all branches.

Local proximity can start with the same sentence or a 30-token window within one field. Treat this as a development parameter, inspect failures, and compare tighter/wider windows. Never join the end of a title to the start of a body to manufacture a name. Semantic similarity and fuzzy matching may propose missed candidates, but neither can by itself establish entity identity.

6. From candidates to defensible article links

Preserve the original title, body, snippet, date fields, URL and collection identifiers privately. Create cleaned analytical text in a separate field. Search each field independently, retaining match offsets and the matching rule. Suppress navigation, related-article blocks, footers, tag lists and duplicated headings in the analytical version while keeping an audit trail. A snippet-only candidate can remain discoverable; it cannot support a detailed frame judgement when the relevant text is absent.

Every proposed organisation-item link passes two separate decisions: **does this refer to the intended entity?** and **is the reference part of the item's substantive content?** Classify accepted links as incidental, substantial or main-subject mentions. Retain rejected and ambiguous cases with reasons rather than silently dropping them.

Use three evidence states: accepted, rejected and unresolved. Record whether acceptance came from a reviewed rule or a human decision. Automated acceptance is available only for a rule whose held-out performance supports the intended use; a numerical confidence score without calibration is not a probability. Unresolved network or entity cases remain outside entity-level counts and visible in uncertainty tables.

The development audit has already exposed specific failure modes: proverbs resembling names; foreign organisations with the same name; a page category joined to a headline; older related stories embedded in newer pages; and social/video tags that list a centre without establishing its involvement. Build these into regression fixtures, alongside genuine inflection, multi-organisation and cross-locality examples. These fixtures check known behaviour; the independent evaluation sample tests generalisation.

Article identity and repetition. First reconcile repeated vendor imports. Then canonicalise publication URLs conservatively, preserving substantive parameters and identifiers. Inspect home pages, reused URLs, missing URLs and changing page content. Keep original versions and dates; an updated page is not automatically a new article. Finally group identical or near-identical stories across publishers as a separate analytical layer. Publications measure distribution; story families measure distinct material. Do not merge two independently reported pieces merely because they share a quote or event.

For near-copy candidates, inspect length ratios and shared word sequences after boilerplate removal. Test several thresholds and inspect boundary cases. Record exact-text groups, near-copy groups and event groups separately. The earliest captured date is the earliest observed appearance, not proof of authorship or direction of influence.

7. Store the links and evidence as separate tables

The primary representation unit is the **organisation-article pair**. One article may represent two associations differently, so article-level sentiment or a single article label cannot substitute for pair-level coding. Passage and speaker records provide the evidence for each pair.

Table	Minimum fields and purpose
Organisations	Study ID; source-frame row; documented legal crosswalk; historical eligibility; seat; orientation; activities; evidence status.
Aliases and relationships	Alias or related entity; type; valid dates; scope; disambiguating cues; documentary source; rule version.
Sources and accounts	Publisher/outlet/account ID; domain; medium; geographical scope; affiliation evidence and dates; publisher-group links where verified.
Items and versions	Internal item ID; vendor IDs; collection route; canonical URL; published/event/observed/updated dates; original and cleaned text; hashes; missingness flags.
Organisation-item links	Pair ID; organisation and item IDs; rule; evidence offsets; entity decision; relevance; prominence; reviewer and adjudication.
Passages and voices	Pair ID; text offsets; speaker; role at the time; quotation/paraphrase; target; coded frame and stance; uncertainty.
Story and event groups	Item membership; grouping method; similarity; inspected status; event place/date; known origin evidence.
Search and review logs	Query; inspected results; retrieval failures; inclusion/exclusion reason; sampling probability; annotation version; coder type.

Use distinct null states for unavailable text, not assessed, genuinely absent and unresolved identity. Validate keys and dates and retain immutable releases of the register, rule set and accepted links. No manual edit of an aggregate table should stand in for a correction to its source decisions.

8. Distinguish medium, affiliation and editorial work

Record three axes rather than one label such as "web":

- **Medium:** web article, print, radio/TV transcript, organisational page, platform post, comment, forum or other.
- **Publisher relationship:** organisation-owned; verified network/partner; external editorial publisher; public institution; public participant; unresolved. Ownership or affiliation needs dated evidence.
- **Production:** original reporting/interview; editorial commentary; organisation-authored statement; attributed republication; mixed adaptation; unclear.

For the primary outcome "substantive independent editorial coverage", require an external editorial publisher, accepted entity/relevance, substantial or main-subject prominence, and original reporting/interview or editorial commentary. Describe attributed reprints and mixed/unclear origins separately and include them only in an explicitly broader sensitivity definition. "Independent" here means editorially separate from the association; it does not imply political neutrality or complete independence of every funding relationship.

An organisation's press release reproduced on a news site is media distribution, but not automatically independent reporting. A municipality's announcement is institutional communication. A church or umbrella outlet may be affiliated and still contain reporting; retain both attributes. For a social account, classify the account and author, not the platform domain. Quoted criticism does not automatically become the journalist's judgement.

9. Validation and review design

Development. Use the 60-organisation pilot and existing review queues to revise names, cleaning, relevance and source rules. Log all changes. The existing 453 records and AI readings stay in this development pool. Record review time and error types; this determines the feasible scale of later manual work.

Held-out link evaluation. After freezing a rule version, draw a new probability sample of candidate organisation-item pairs. An initial planning range is 400-600 pairs, adjusted for the desired uncertainty and route sizes. Stratify by match route, ambiguity risk, medium, text completeness and candidate frequency; ensure coverage beyond the pilot. Oversample risky and rare routes, retaining inclusion probabilities. Assign whole story families and their organisation links to development or evaluation to prevent repeated text leaking across the split. Estimate overall and route-specific precision with design weights and uncertainty that respects story clustering. A small route with too few independent stories remains unvalidated.

Two readers independently judge entity identity and relevance before adjudication, without seeing a model's proposed decision. Record ambiguous outcomes separately and report how their treatment changes precision. Evaluate unseen organisations separately where feasible: success on new articles about familiar names is not the same as generalising to unseen names. Choose sample sizes using expected error rates and actual cluster sizes after the pilot; 400-600 is a workload allowance, not a power guarantee.

A proposed operational target for automatic counting is at least 95% estimated precision with a 95% lower confidence bound above 90% in the intended population. This is a prospective decision threshold, not a claimed result. If a route fails or its interval is too wide, narrow the rule or manually verify its accepted links. Any revision learned from the evaluation set requires a fresh holdout before reporting new accuracy.

Missed coverage. Sample organisations with no retrieved items and those awaiting rules, retaining their distinct statuses. Begin with about 60 cases distributed across counties, name types and missing-channel patterns. Apply the standard web/event protocol and add known relevant articles as positive controls. Measure recovery of this benchmark and describe the newly found failures; do not call it total recall. If estimating the frequency of discoverable missed coverage, use probability selection and weights within explicitly defined zero/held strata. Search-engine discovery is still an imperfect benchmark.

Representation coding. Develop the substantive codebook on approximately 80-120 diverse accepted pairs, then freeze it. Use a separate probability sample for frame/voice prevalence if a full census is infeasible. Double-code at least 20-25% of that sample, or all of it when small. Report per-code agreement and an appropriate chance-adjusted measure, disagreement patterns, effective denominators and adjudication. Do not collapse reliability to a single overall score when rare or ambiguous labels behave differently.

Feasible output if readers are unavailable. Continue retrieval diagnostics, text-availability descriptions, clearly marked computational topic exploration and AI-assisted case proposals. Keep human fields blank. Do not present frame percentages, a verified visibility league table or human

reliability statistics as established. Independent review is a condition for those claims, not a reason to stop all exploratory work.

10. Descriptive analysis: who appears, where and how often?

Produce a coverage funnel first: all frame members; historical eligibility known/unknown; rules ready/held; candidates; accepted substantive links; channel resolved/unresolved. Present excluded and unresolved categories alongside the analytic totals. Only after this can a reader understand a zero.

Indicator	Definition and denominator	Display
Observed organisations	Eligible organisations with at least one accepted substantive item, separately by channel, divided by eligible organisations with completed search protocols. Also show counts against the full frame and unresolved remainder.	Funnel and county table.
Volume and prominence	Distinct publications, organisation-publication pairs and substantial/main-subject subsets; label the unit each time.	Bars and distribution plots.
Persistence	Months with coverage divided by historically eligible, adequately monitored months; also show raw month counts.	Organisation-by-month heatmap.
Editorial breadth	Distinct verified editorial outlets, and separately verified publisher groups.	Distribution and selected profiles.
Attention concentration	Shares and Lorenz/Gini for accepted organisation-item counts in a defined channel; include eligible completed-search zeros. Multi-organisation articles contribute once to each pair.	Lorenz curve and top-share table.
Geography	Registered seat, activity place and outlet scope shown separately. County association shares are context, not an activity or audience measure.	Three aligned maps or small multiples.
Relative monitored visibility	10,000 times deduplicated eligible matched items divided by all deduplicated eligible monitored items in the same month/source panel. Count each matched item once in the national numerator.	Timeline with coverage bands.
Publicity and reporting	Own, affiliated, institutional, editorial and discussion volumes side by side; unknowns visible.	Stacked counts and channel profiles.

Do not divide deduplicated article counts by raw vendor rows. Do not sum organisation-level attention as though it were a count of unique articles. A zero denominator yields an undefined ratio, not zero. No organisation is called "invisible" simply because rules are incomplete or source coverage is weak.

Keep 2025 as the main comparison. A later 2021-2026 extension needs source-regime indicators, historical names and eligibility for each year, missing-day checks and a comparable-outlet panel. The April 2024 collection change and partial 2026 period prevent a simple unqualified growth story. A common panel is a sensitivity analysis, not a correction for all unobserved sources.

11. Exploratory analysis: themes, language and organisational profiles

Themes. Analyse both the association-relevant passages and the complete cleaned article. Begin with a transparent TF-IDF/NMF baseline and compare several topic counts, for example 6, 8, 10 and 12, with multiple starts. Inspect representative and poorly fitting passages before naming topics. Compare publication-weighted results with one representative per story family and a web-editorial-only subset. If the accepted corpus is small or unstable, use a manually developed thematic matrix instead of forcing a topic model.

Candidate activity themes include volunteering, social services, education, cultural events, meditation/yoga, worship and spiritual practice, wellbeing, environmental activities and civic advocacy. These are starting prompts, not compulsory bins. Allow topics the register did not predict. Report model topic shares as computational groupings, not human-coded prevalence of social functions.

Vocabulary and associations. Use Croatian-aware lemmatisation while preserving negation, relevant verbs and multiword concepts. Keep actor names separate from concepts. Examine words surrounding each association, activity and identity label in the same sentence or adjacent original sentences within one field. Pair frequencies and association scores need the same sentence universe. Test support thresholds and remove widely repeated sentences to check whether one press release drives an apparent conceptual relationship.

Organisational profiles. Compare verified organisations by activities, channel composition, event dependence, outlet breadth and representation. Use counts and uncertainty before attempting clustering. At fewer than 20 independent story families, prefer counts and qualitative portraits; at 20-49, broad profiles; at 50 or more, richer comparisons may be feasible. These are presentation heuristics, not statistical adequacy thresholds. Unknown orientation remains its own visible category, and name-based lexical strata never become substantive group labels.

Networks. First draw organisation-outlet and organisation-event bipartite networks. Treat co-mention as co-mention, not collaboration or ideological affinity. Create a collaboration edge only from an explicitly evidenced relationship. Compare network summaries after removing boilerplate, replicated stories and very high-volume events.

12. Representation codebook: what a passage says about an association

Code at the pair or passage level and retain evidence spans. Most dimensions permit several labels. The coding form must include unknown/insufficient-evidence states and distinguish a passage's speaker from the publisher.

Dimension	Initial operational categories
Prominence	Name only/incidental; substantive participant; main subject; title or lead presence as separate flags.
Public role	Service provider; community organiser; religious/spiritual actor; cultural/educational actor; wellbeing provider; advocate; expert; partner; subject of scrutiny; other.
Activity and issue	What the association does in this item and which issue it addresses; multiple activities allowed.
Identity salience	Explicit religious/spiritual label; described practice without identity label; identity absent from available relevant text; contested identity; insufficient text.
Naming and attribution	Exact/short name; network label; generic group label; identity assigned by self, journalist, official, expert or critic.
Voice	Direct quotation; attributed paraphrase; association-authored text; no organisational voice; unclear. Separately code beneficiaries, volunteers, officials, experts and critics.
Representational frame	Public benefit/solidarity; everyday community; tradition/belonging; spirituality/practice; health/wellbeing; expertise; civic rights/policy; curiosity/exoticism; conflict/risk; accountability; other.
Target-specific stance	Supportive; critical; mixed; descriptive/no explicit evaluation; indeterminate. Identify the target: association, activity, leader, belief or policy.
Argument and evidence	Description; invitation; testimonial; evidence-based explanation; normative justification; allegation; response; finding by an identified authority.
Agency and context	Active organiser or passive object; contextual explanation present/absent; opportunity to respond where a criticism is made; uncertainty about missing context.

Frames describe how a text organises meaning. "Conflict/risk" must be supported by the passage; it cannot be inferred from a negative sentiment score. A critical quotation and a supportive journalist's account can coexist. An allegation, an organisation's response and a documented institutional finding must remain different evidence categories.

The most useful comparison is often **documented self-description versus editorial depiction**: does an association that describes a spiritual mission appear publicly through welfare work, culture, expertise or dispute? Build paired profiles using contemporaneous documents and articles. Describe a difference in emphasis before attributing intentions such as concealment, secularisation or hostility.

Whole-text sentiment can be tested as an auxiliary feature only after target-specific validation. Do not convert vendor sentiment, reactions or engagement totals into public trust, hostility or influence. Platform engagement can be described within comparable platforms and capture periods when definitions and missingness are known; it is not an audience census.

13. Investigative phase: explain selected patterns with evidence

Select about 8-12 organisational portraits and 3-4 event dossiers after the descriptive map. This is purposive explanation, not a prevalence sample. Include contrasting cases: substantial editorial attention; mostly own-channel activity; persistent local coverage; brief event-driven attention; contested or surprising framing; shared-network ambiguity; and documented activity with little observed reporting. Vary activity, geography and documented orientation without forcing symmetry unsupported by the frame.

Investigation	Evidence to assemble	What the inquiry can establish
Public benefit and spiritual identity	Same-period mission documents, activity reports, own announcements and editorial coverage.	Which activities and identities are foregrounded or omitted in those texts.
From announcement to news	Timestamped statements, article versions, attribution and repeated passages.	Observed reuse, added voices and changes in framing; not unseen editorial intent.
A peak of attention	All retrieved items around an event, story families, timeline and source coverage.	Whether volume reflects many reports, repeated publicity, one controversy or several unrelated events.
Local activity with little observed coverage	Dated activities, standardised local searches, partner records and publisher coverage audit.	Documented activity and search limits; possible explanations, not proof of suppression.
A contested representation	Complete article sequence, cited primary documents, organisational response and later correction or resolution if available.	Which claims were made, by whom, and how later evidence bears on them.
Organisational capacity and public resources	Matched legal identity, available annual/financial reports, public grant decisions and documented partnerships.	Context for communications capacity and public role; no automatic inference of influence or impropriety.

For an event dossier, start with a window from 30 days before to 60 days after the documented event, adjusting transparently if the sequence began earlier or continued. Record daily items, sources, quotations, frames, repeated text and the first observed appearance. Include quiet comparison periods and seek disconfirming material, not only dramatic examples.

For each dossier write: the observation that motivated selection; two or more plausible explanations; an evidence chronology; a claim-by-claim source table; contrary evidence; unresolved gaps; and a bounded conclusion. Compare press-release language with what journalists added, removed or challenged. Distinguish different outlets from independent sources when several repeat the same statement.

Official contextual sources include the Register of Nonprofit Organisations, whose ministry page provides register access and a digital-data link. The Ministry also describes public financial reporting through that register. Use a verified legal crosswalk and the appropriate reporting year; missing reports or figures are not evidence of wrongdoing. Municipal/county grant decisions and organisations' own reports can add case-specific context where accessible.

Documentary investigation can proceed with public evidence. Interviews, requests for comment or surveys would be a separately specified extension with explicit authorisation for contact. No such

outreach is part of this planning task. Where an adverse factual claim remains disputed, preserve its attribution and unresolved status rather than turning it into an established finding.

14. Comparisons, uncertainty and analysis limits

Start with distributions and contrasts. If sample sizes and covariate completeness support modelling, use separate models for any observed editorial coverage and the volume among observed organisations. A logistic/hurdle or count model is a candidate, with overdispersion and exposure assessed rather than assumed. Potential predictors include verified age, activity, seat, documented network membership, communications channels and comparable financial scale. Preserve missingness and explain who drops out of any complete-case model.

For representation, observations are clustered within organisations, outlets, story families and events. Use a tractable design with appropriate clustered uncertainty or a limited multilevel model when there are enough independent groups. Do not treat thousands of duplicated posts as thousands of independent observations. Sample-coded estimates require inclusion weights; purposive cases cannot supply population percentages.

Model associations are exploratory. Resource measures may themselves reflect visibility; orientation groups may differ in activities and location; media opportunities are not randomly assigned. Avoid causal effects or a claim that spirituality "causes" coverage. Account for multiple exploratory comparisons by emphasising effect sizes, uncertainty and replication across specifications rather than isolated p-values.

Every substantive figure should have at least the relevant sensitivity checks: conservative versus expanded identity links; articles versus all channels; original editorial work versus attributed reprints; publications versus story families; relevant passage versus whole document; complete text versus title/snippet only; baseline feed versus unfiltered/supplementary collection; and comparable-source panels. Show where the story changes. Do not hide an unstable conclusion behind one preferred specification.

15. Work packages, handoffs and completion criteria

The first deliverable should be a tested 60-organisation media pilot, followed by a national expansion. The existing pilot is a development set; national descriptive claims depend on completing comparable search and eligibility work beyond it.

Work package	Concrete output	Completion criterion
A. Freeze the design and sources	Register/media manifests, historical-eligibility rules, source coverage and three collection scopes.	Every input and population has a version, date range and explicit gap log.
B. Resolve the pilot identities	Sixty evidence dossiers, aliases, channel map, network decisions and revised codebook.	Each case is resolved or explicitly unresolved, with dated evidence and measured review effort.
C. Retrieve and clean	Field-specific matches, unfiltered-export increment, logged web searches and a cleaned candidate collection.	Reproducible queries; no cross-field matches; known failure fixtures pass; every retained match has provenance.

Work package	Concrete output	Completion criterion
D. Validate and extend	Fresh held-out evaluation; apparent-miss audit; wider identity coverage across the frame.	Accuracy and uncertainty reported for supported routes; other links manually reviewed or labelled unresolved.
E. Describe and explore	Coverage funnel, geography, timeline, channel profiles, topics, language and story-family controls.	Every indicator has a defined unit, denominator and sensitivity table.
F. Code representation	Frozen codebook, independent annotations, adjudication and appropriately weighted summaries.	Reliability and unresolved categories are reported; no human labels are inferred from AI output.
G. Investigate cases	Eight to twelve portraits and three to four event dossiers, with source and counterevidence logs.	Interpretations trace to evidence and address plausible alternatives.
H. Write and release	Technical report, Croatian public report and paper outline with a claim register.	Numerical reconciliation, disclosure review and visual QA completed; release scope explicitly recorded.

The sequence is dependency-based. Source inventory and identity enrichment can proceed together; descriptive checks can start while human review proceeds; interpretive claims wait for the relevant evidence. Measure time on the pilot before scheduling the full frame. As a planning illustration, even 30 minutes of identity work per organisation would take about 663 hours for all 1,325 entries, before article coding. Sixty pilot dossiers at that rate take 30 hours. These are workload illustrations, not measured estimates or a delivery promise.

Immediate next execution batch: freeze 2025 manifests; complete the 60 identity dossiers; implement field-specific cleaning and the new link states; search those organisations in the available unfiltered exports; run the standard miss searches; deliver a pilot memo with yield, error types, unresolved identities and measured effort. Use that memo to size the national enrichment and review workload. This batch produces a concrete basis for expansion without treating the current candidate counts as findings.

16. Planned outputs and project placement

Keep the work within studies/spirituality-associations/, alongside the existing atlas. This plan extends PROTOCOL.md; it does not overwrite the completed exploration. The following locations are proposed for execution; they are not claims that those outputs already exist.

Location	Intended contents
media/	Collection, entity-linking, cleaning, validation, coding and analysis scripts; source configuration and reproducible commands.
output/private/media/v1/	Evidence dossiers, saved source pages, full text, identifiers, URLs, search logs, link decisions and annotation sheets.
output/tables/media-v1/	Disclosure-checked aggregates, coverage and quality summaries, figure inputs and release manifests.
output/figures/media-v1/	Exportable scientific figures with source tables and clear denominators.

Location	Intended contents
output/report/	Technical findings and case synthesis for the study.
Repository output/pdf/	Reader-facing PDF editions, including this research plan.

The report sequence should read naturally: study population and collection; the distribution of attention; what associations are visible for; their language and public roles; whose voices are heard; differences across media; organisational and event portraits; and what these findings imply for the mediated visibility of spirituality-related civil society.

Plan eight main visuals: a coverage funnel; geography separating seat and activity; a monthly channel timeline; a concentration plot; a theme-by-channel heatmap; a voice/prominence matrix; a self-description versus editorial-frame comparison; and an event chronology with repeated stories marked. Add a small organisation-outlet network only if it clarifies the findings. Avoid a dense decorative network or a ranking unsupported by complete identity work.

Maintain two complementary editions, following the reference project: a technical report with methods, provenance and sensitivity results, and a Croatian public report organised around findings and readable examples. Keep essential scope and uncertainty intelligible in both. A concise public edition must not turn tentative evidence into settled conclusions.

Restricted media text, article URLs, row identifiers, personal contacts and coding sheets stay private under the project's data policy. Public-source citations and suitable aggregates can support the report; named organisational comparisons require completed entity checks and the intended disclosure review. Keep a claim register tying every number and interpretation to its table or evidence dossier. Record AI assistance separately from human annotation.

17. Source notes and status

Local methodological references: studies/demokrscanstvo-barometar/public-report/README.md and build.py; studies/demokrscanstvo-barometar/report/README.md; quality_reports/plans/2026-09-19_demokrscanstvo-analytical-story.md; and quality_reports/plans/2026-09-19_demokrscanstvo-analysis-execution.md. These establish the report structure, passage analysis, repeated-story controls and the distinction between computational results and human-coded claims.

Local empirical baseline: exploratory report, protocol, codebook, official website evidence, and the saved register_audit.json, media_snapshot.json, candidate_audit.json, filter_audit.json and profile_audit.json in output/tables/. The number of screened names without candidates is 1,043 minus 248 = 795. No candidate total is presented as validated coverage.

Official entry points checked on 19 September 2026: Ministry of Justice, Public Administration and Digital Transformation, Register of Associations; Ministry of Finance, Register of Nonprofit Organisations; Ministry of Finance, nonprofit organisations and public financial reporting. Links are provided where each source is used. Availability of an entry point does not establish complete historical coverage or authorise an assumption about a particular association.

Status: research plan drafted from the completed exploration and the reference study. Expanded media retrieval, the proposed human validation, representation coding, investigative dossiers and the resulting substantive findings remain future work. This is an exploratory protocol, not a retrospective preregistration.